

TaskForge

Hierarchical emergency-response processing using Composite, Iterator, State and Decorator.

System description

TaskForge models emergency-response management across a city. A command structure can contain districts, sectors, incidents and individual response vehicles. The hierarchy lets a dispatcher treat one vehicle and an entire incident group through the same `EmergencyTask` abstraction.

The system addresses four operational needs: recursive dispatch across nested teams; independent views of active work; a controlled ambulance lifecycle with rejected invalid actions; and optional responsibilities such as priority handling and audit logging that can be stacked at runtime.

HIERARCHY

Command -> district -> sector -> incident -> vehicle.

TRAVERSAL

Complete depth-first snapshots and reverse direct-unit views.

LIFECYCLE

Pending through Completed or Cancelled, with invalid actions rejected.

RUNTIME ROLES

Priority and audit decorators remain usable as `EmergencyTask` objects.

Team

Riti Botha

Member 1

Deon Steenkamp

Member 2

Connor Human

Member 3

Gang of Four participant mapping

PATTERN	PARTICIPANT	TASKFORGE CLASS
Composite	Component	EmergencyTask
Composite	Leaf	dispatchAmbulance
Composite	Composite	IncidentGroup
Iterator	Iterator	TaskIterator
Iterator	ConcreteIterator	DepthFirstIterator, ReverseIterator, StandardIterator, NullIterator
Iterator	Aggregate	EmergencyTask
Iterator	ConcreteAggregate	IncidentGroup, dispatchAmbulance
Decorator	Component	EmergencyTask
Decorator	Decorator	EmergencyTaskDecorator
Decorator	ConcreteDecorator	PriorityDispatchDecorator, AuditDispatchDecorator
State	Context	dispatchAmbulance
State	State	TaskState
State	ConcreteState	PendingState, DispatchedState, EnRouteState, OnSceneState, CompletedState, CancelledState

Runtime collaboration

IncidentGroup recursively owns other groups or leaves. Its factory methods create traversal objects without exposing the internal vector to the client. A leaf delegates lifecycle actions to its current TaskState. Decorators wrap any task while preserving the EmergencyTask interface.

Coherent application: the patterns meet in the runtime scenarios rather than being run as four isolated examples. Decorated vehicles live inside the composite, are discovered by iterators and participate in normal dispatch behavior; a dedicated lifecycle scenario demonstrates State transitions.

Relationships, multiplicities and ownership

Composite hierarchy

`IncidentGroup` composes zero or more `EmergencyTask` children (1 to 0..*). It owns each child exclusively, deletes all remaining children in its destructor and deletes an item when `remove()` is called.

`dispatchAmbulance` and `IncidentGroup` inherit publicly from the abstract component, so client code can dispatch a leaf or a whole nested incident uniformly.

Decorator ownership

`EmergencyTaskDecorator` composes exactly one wrapped task (1 to 1) and deletes it. This makes stacked decorators recursively self-cleaning. `AuditDispatchDecorator` instead holds a non-owning association to one caller-managed `EmergencyAuditLog`; zero or more audit decorators may share the same log.

State ownership

`dispatchAmbulance` composes one active `TaskState`. The context deletes the old State on every transition and deletes the final State in its destructor. Concrete State classes receive the context only as a transient method parameter.

Iterator lifetime

Concrete iterators store non-owning snapshot copies of `EmergencyTask*` values (1 to 0..*). The aggregate retains ownership of the tasks. Iterator objects returned by the factories transfer to the caller and are managed with `std::unique_ptr<TaskIterator>`. Leaves return a `NullIterator`, allowing traversal code to terminate uniformly without exposing a container.

Removal contract: snapshots preserve membership across additions, but they do not extend pointee lifetime. Because `remove()` deletes a child, all active iterators are invalidated before a removal; the client must destroy them first and create fresh iterators afterward.

Concrete domain behavior

- The runtime tree contains three nested `IncidentGroup` levels below the command root before reaching response vehicles.
- `DepthFirstIterator` visits the complete nested structure; `ReverseIterator` presents direct incident units in reverse order; snapshots can coexist independently.
- `PriorityDispatchDecorator` emits an urgency instruction and `AuditDispatchDecorator` records start/completion entries. They are stacked on rescue and hazmat units.
- Six concrete States enforce valid progression and explain rejected lifecycle actions.

UML object diagram

Runtime object diagram – power-plant fire response

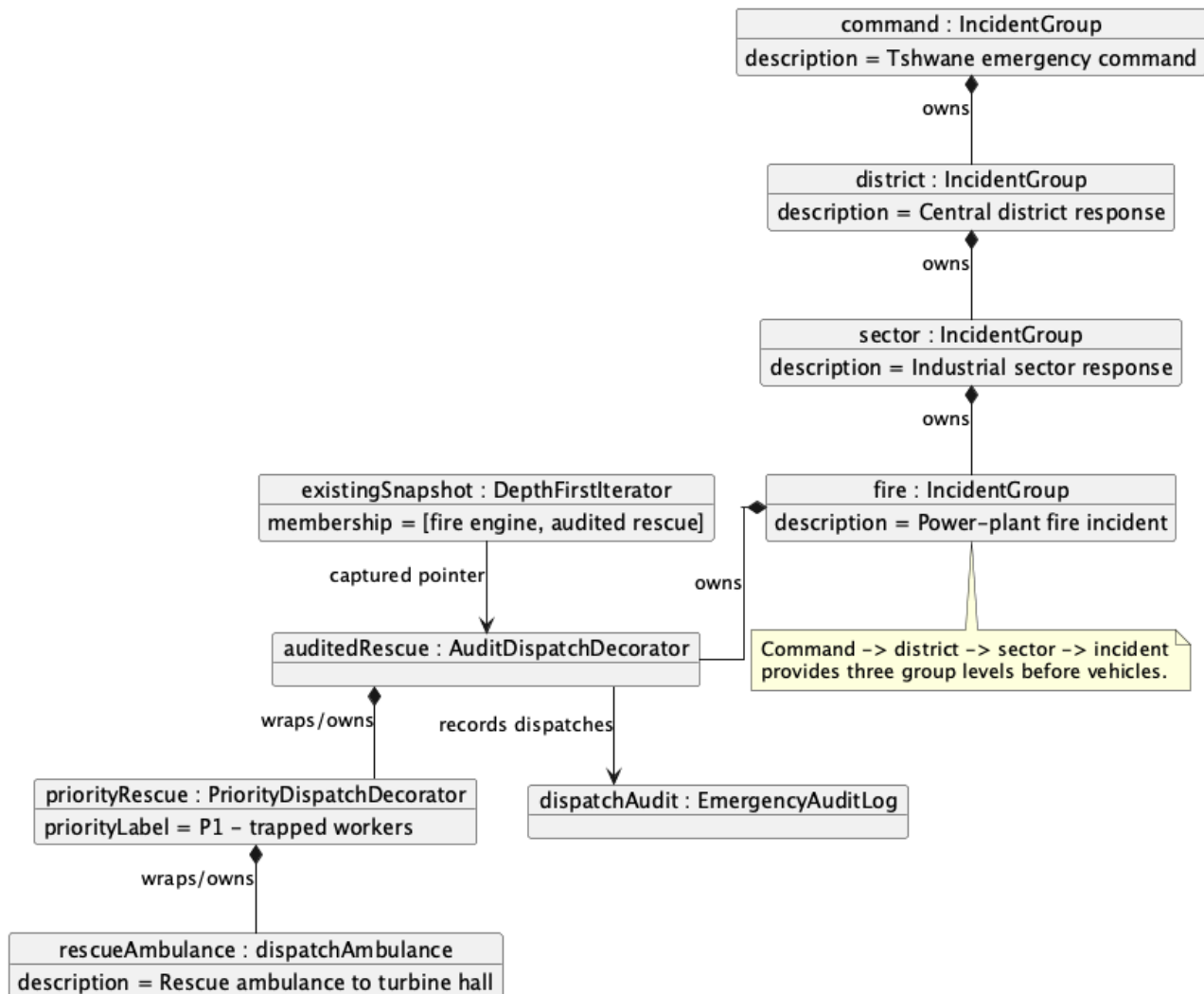


Figure 2. Runtime slice of the nested response hierarchy. The diagram shows three group levels below the command root, a stacked priority/audit decorator chain, the shared audit sink and an existing depth-first snapshot.

UML state diagram

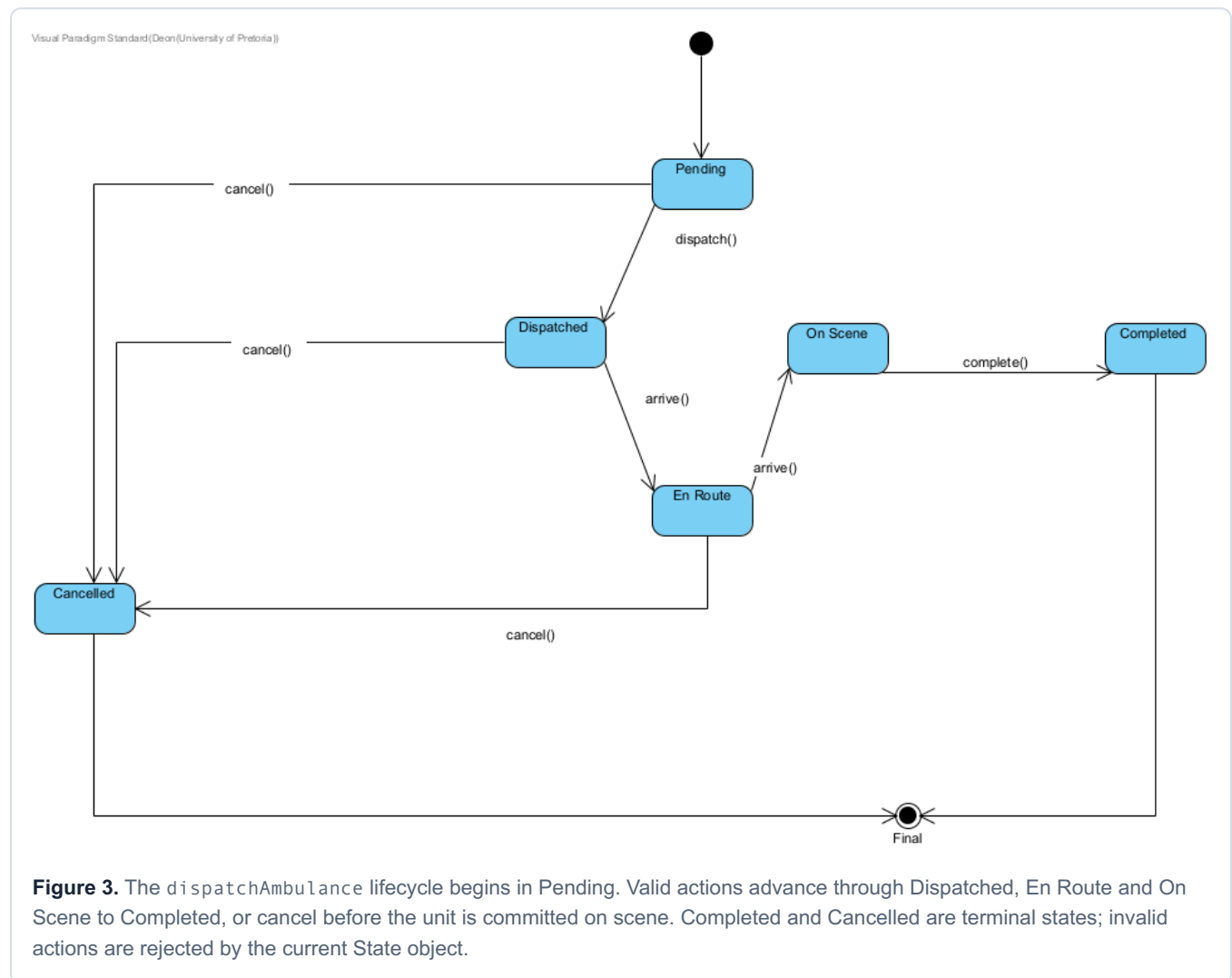
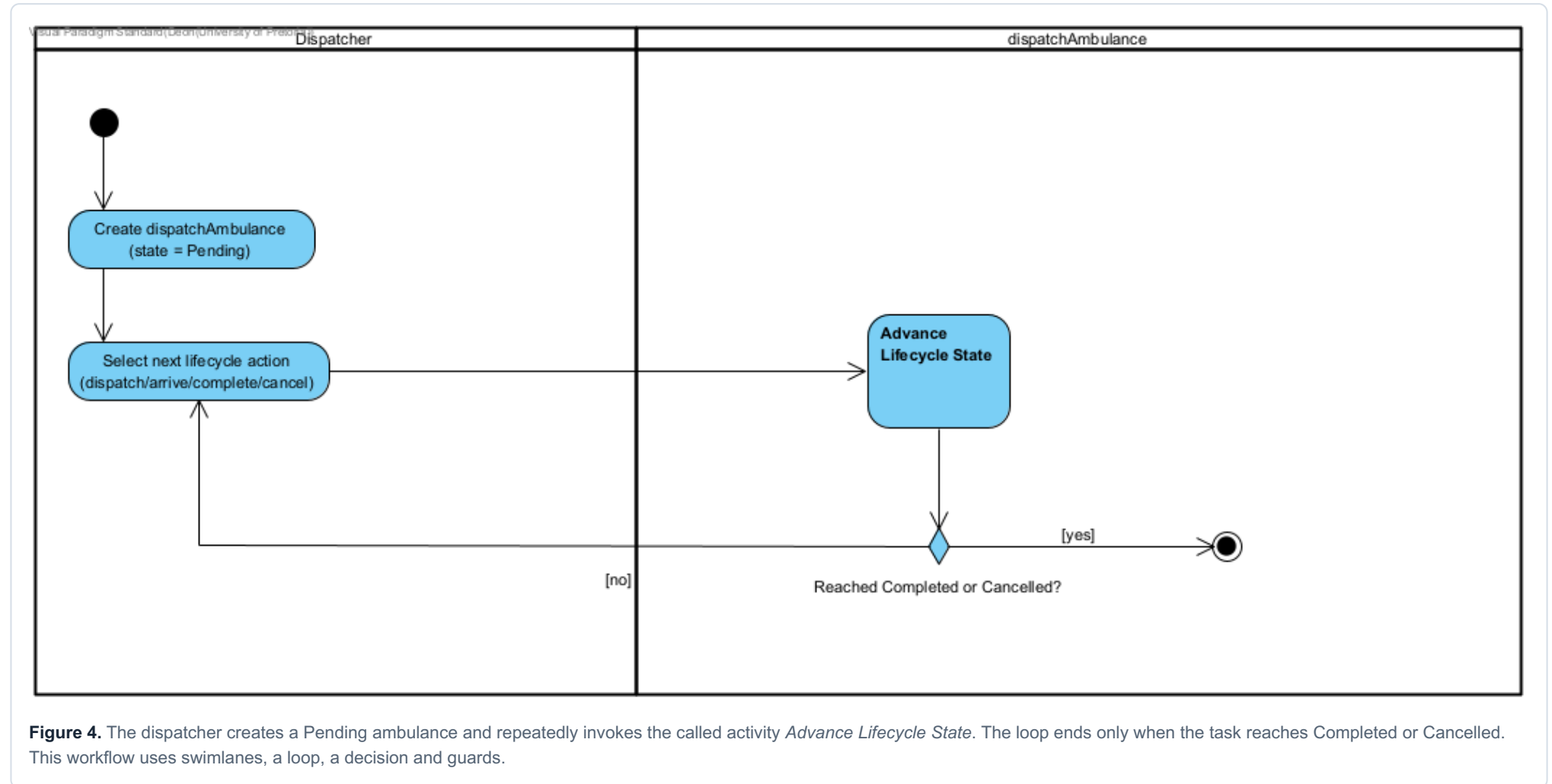


Figure 3. The `dispatchAmbulance` lifecycle begins in **Pending**. Valid actions advance through **Dispatched**, **En Route** and **On Scene** to **Completed**, or `cancel` before the unit is committed on scene. **Completed** and **Cancelled** are terminal states; invalid actions are rejected by the current State object.

Ambulance lifecycle progression



Advance Lifecycle State

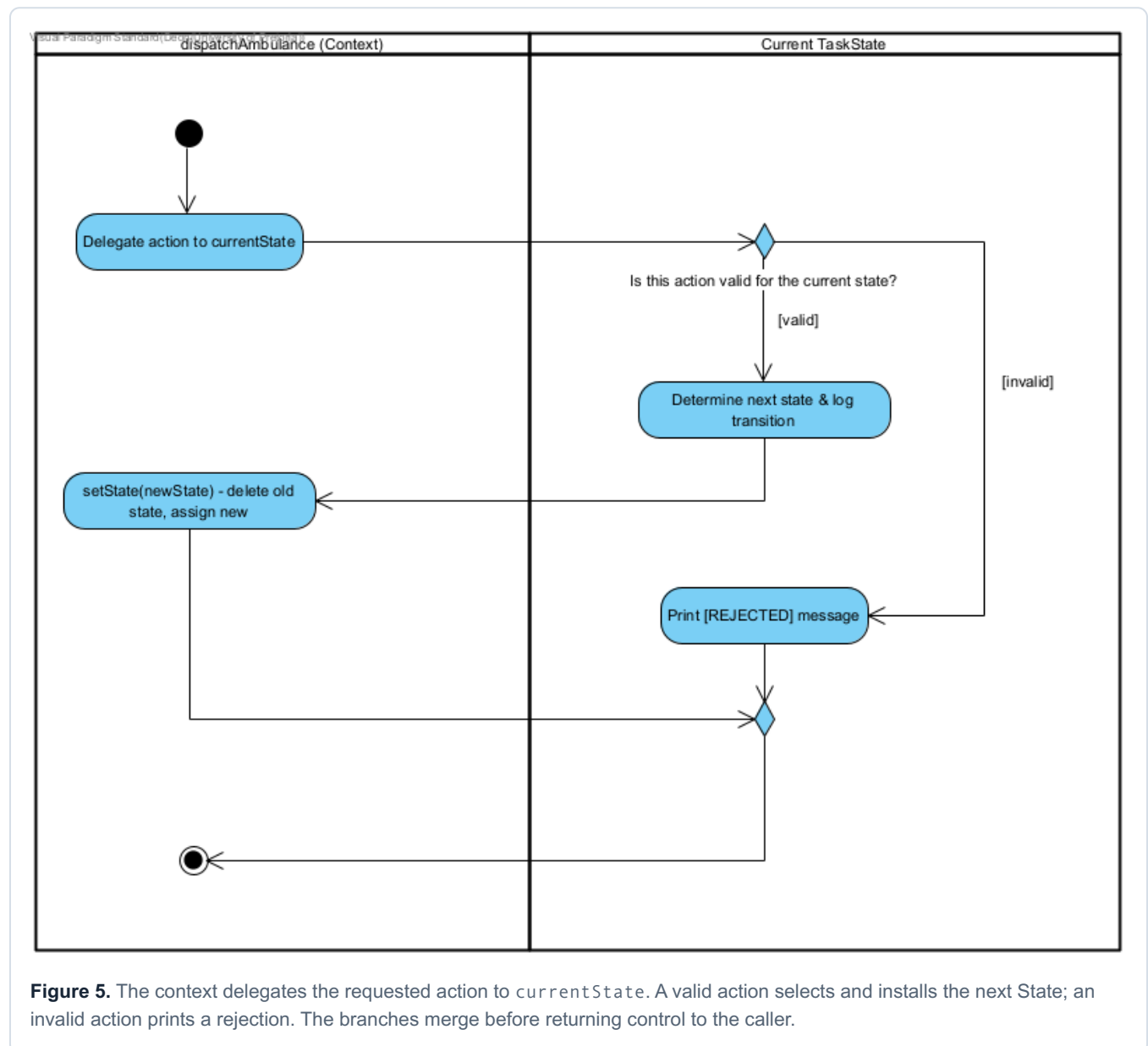


Figure 5. The context delegates the requested action to `currentState`. A valid action selects and installs the next State; an invalid action prints a rejection. The branches merge before returning control to the caller.

Emergency response reconfiguration - Part A

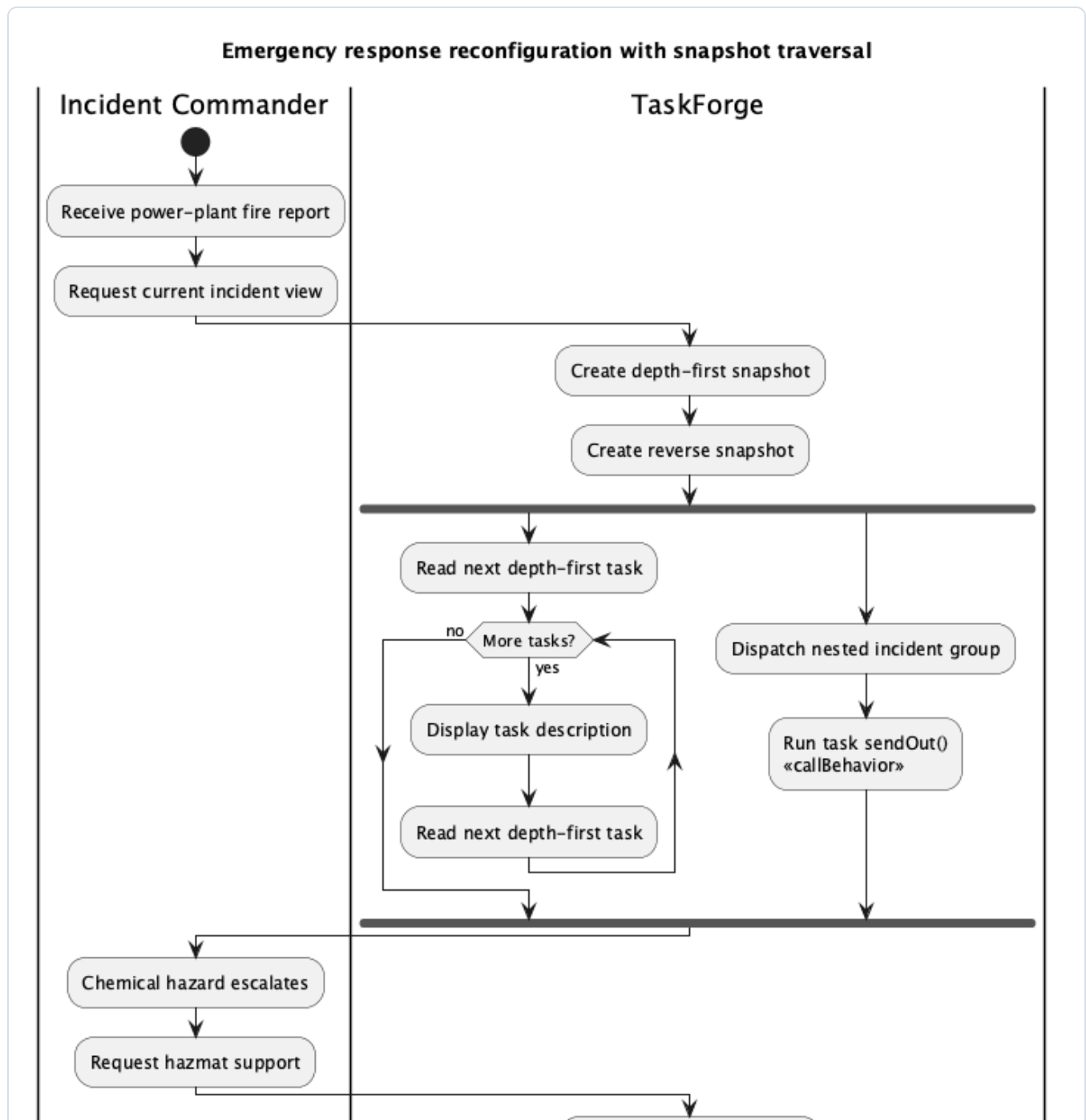


Figure 6A. The incident commander requests a view. TaskForge creates independent snapshots, traverses the hierarchy visibly and dispatches the nested incident in parallel using a fork/join.

Traceability: snapshot creation and the traversal loop map to `createIterator()`, `first()`, `isDone()`, `currentItem()` and `next()`; recursive dispatch maps to `IncidentGroup::sendOut()`.

Emergency response reconfiguration - Part B

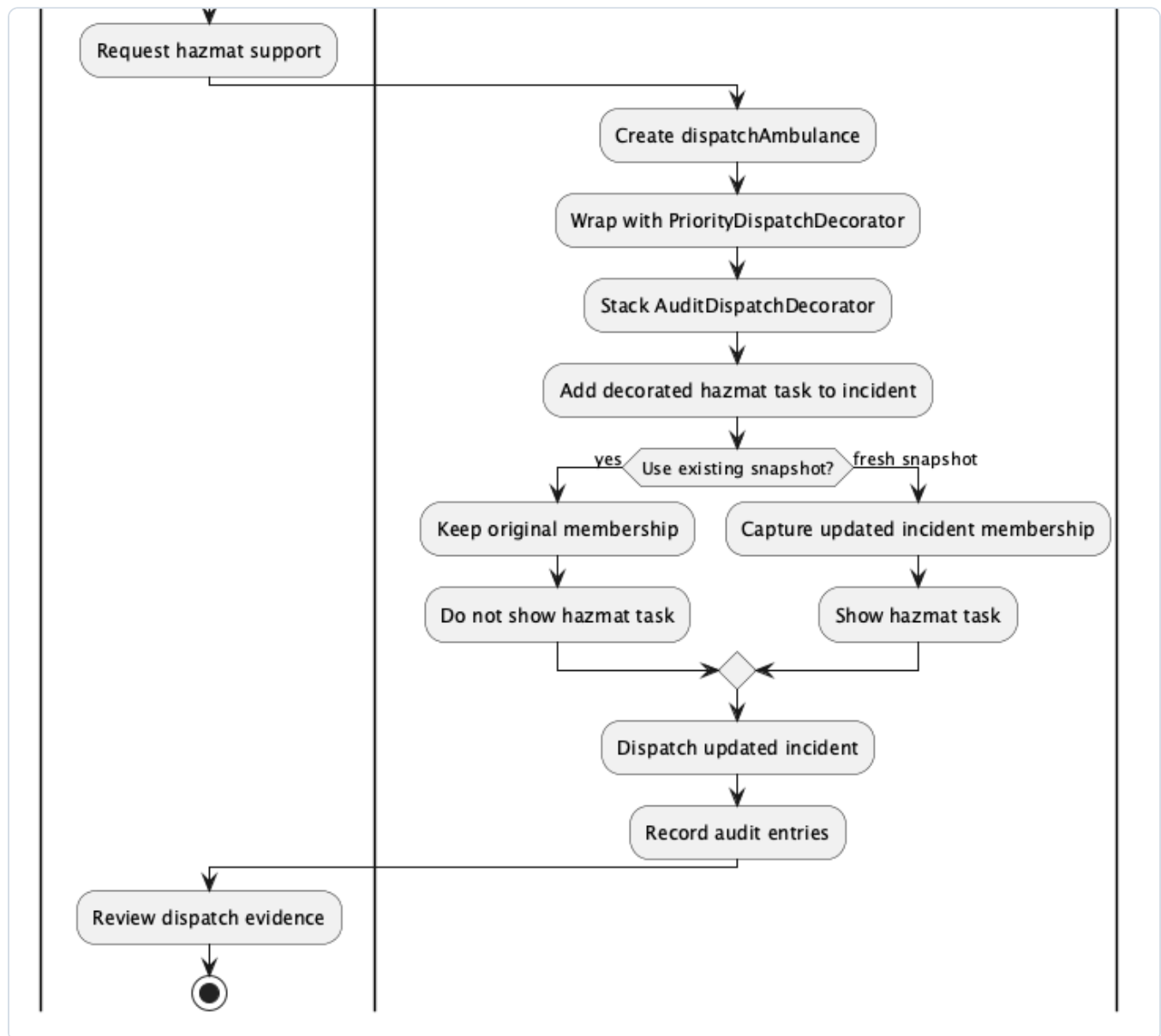
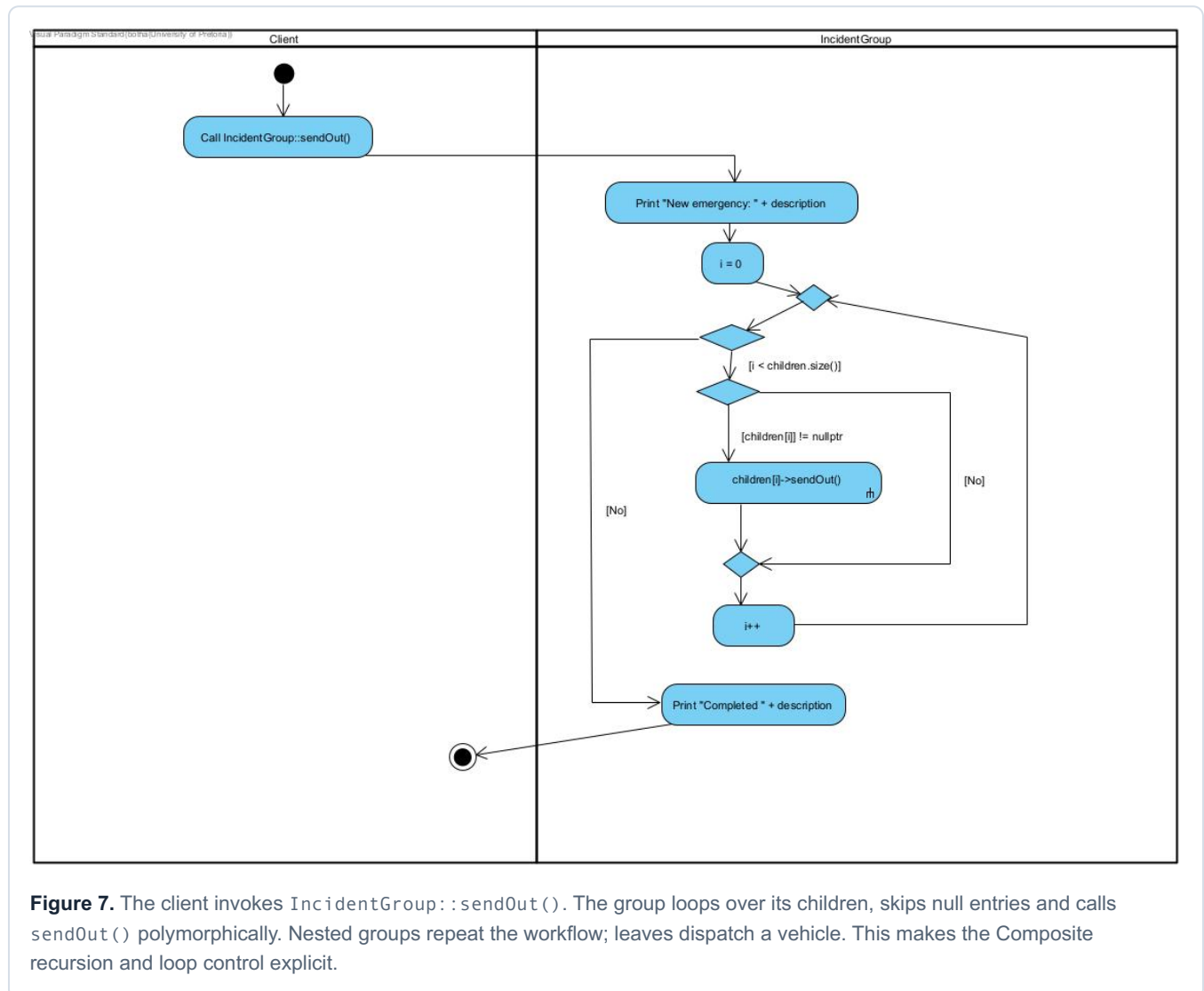


Figure 6B. A new hazmat task is created, wrapped first with priority behavior and then audit behavior, and added at runtime. The old snapshot keeps its original membership while a new snapshot sees the addition.

Traceability: the workflow maps directly to `scenarioTwo()`, including decorator construction, `IncidentGroup::add()`, the old/new snapshot comparison and the updated dispatch.

Recursive IncidentGroup dispatch



Workflow coverage and traversal policy

REQUIRED NOTATION OR BEHAVIOR	WHERE DEMONSTRATED
Actions, decisions, guards and merges	Lifecycle called activity; emergency reconfiguration; recursive group dispatch
Loops	Lifecycle progression, visible iterator loop and <code>IncidentGroup</code> child loop
Fork/join	Emergency-response traversal and nested dispatch branches
Called/composite activity	<i>Advance Lifecycle State</i> and its detailed activity
Swimlanes	Dispatcher/context, commander/ <code>TaskForge</code> and client/group responsibilities
Traversal visible in a larger workflow	Emergency-response reconfiguration
Lifecycle conditional behavior	State validity decision and rejected-action branch

Snapshot traversal with invalidation on removal

Each iterator copies task pointers into a private flat vector and advances using `currentPos`. An iterator already in progress is isolated from additions: it keeps its original membership, while an iterator created afterward captures the updated tree. Multiple iterators can therefore navigate independently.

Removal has a different, deliberate policy. `IncidentGroup::remove()` immediately deletes the child. Because snapshots are non-owning, a removal invalidates every active iterator. Client code must destroy all active iterators before removal and create fresh iterators afterward. This documented invalidation policy is safe when respected and matches the implementation.

Runtime verification: `scenarioTwo()` creates an iterator, adds a decorated hazmat unit, proves the old iterator does not see it, then proves a new iterator does. No removal is performed while a snapshot is active.

GDB bug investigation

Symptom

During development, a focused ambulance transition test reported 32 bytes definitely lost in four blocks - exactly one leaked TaskState object for each transition performed.

```
==23== HEAP SUMMARY:
==23==    in use at exit: 32 bytes in 4 blocks
==23== LEAK SUMMARY:
==23==    definitely lost: 32 bytes in 4 blocks
==23== ERROR SUMMARY: 4 errors from 4 contexts
```

Cause and GDB evidence

The buggy setState() overwrote currentState without deleting the previous State. GDB was run inside Docker with a breakpoint on dispatchAmbulance::setState. Printing both pointers before stepping showed the original PendingState address being replaced and becoming unreachable.

```
Breakpoint 1, dispatchAmbulance::setState
  this=0x609bb706b2b0, newState=0x609bb706c320
$1 = (TaskState *) 0x609bb706b2f0    [original PendingState]
$2 = (TaskState *) 0x609bb706c320    [incoming DispatchedState]
(next)
$3 = (TaskState *) 0x609bb706c320    [currentState after assignment]
```

Correction and focused verification

```
void dispatchAmbulance::setState(TaskState* newState) {
    delete currentState;
    currentState = newState;
}
```

The focused transition test was rerun after the correction: all eight allocations were freed and Valgrind reported zero errors. The complete source evidence is retained in gdb_valgrind_evidence_BUGGY.log, gdb_valgrind_evidence_BUGGY_gdb.log and gdb_valgrind_evidence_FIXED.log.

Docker build and final Valgrind evidence

The final working tree was rebuilt from the supplied `ubuntu:24.04` Dockerfile. The image installs `g++`, `make`, `GDB` and `Valgrind`; `make` compiles every translation unit with `-std=c++11 -g` and produces the required `taskforge` executable.

```
$ docker build -t taskforge-env .  
...  
RUN make  
g++ -std=c++11 -g *.cpp -o taskforge  
Successfully built taskforge-env  
  
$ valgrind --leak-check=full --show-leak-kinds=all ./taskforge  
==28== HEAP SUMMARY:  
==28==    in use at exit: 0 bytes in 0 blocks  
==28==   total heap usage: 247 allocs, 247 frees, 110,317 bytes allocated  
==28== All heap blocks were freed -- no leaks are possible  
==28== ERROR SUMMARY: 0 errors from 0 contexts (suppressed: 0 from 0)
```

PASS

C++11 Makefile build

PASS

Three integrated runtime scenarios

PASS

0 bytes in use at exit

PASS

0 Valgrind errors

Final evidence recorded on 8 September 2026 in `final_valgrind.log`. Earlier buggy/fixed State investigation logs are retained separately to preserve the debugging history.

Collaboration and contribution statement

Work was divided by pattern and tooling responsibility, then integrated through GitHub. The class diagram was co-created so each pattern shared the same domain model instead of becoming a disconnected example.

Selected repository evidence

REFERENCE	CONTRIBUTION	WHY IT MATTERS
f2e7247	Riti - Add Makefile	Established the required C++11 build and taskforge target.
PR #1 / 0bda198	Merge Member2	Integrated Deon's isolated State-pattern work into the main design.
9a4d1bd	Connor - Member 3 Contribution	Integrated Decorator behavior, runtime scenarios, Docker support and Member 3 diagrams.
237c42c	Deon - GDB/Valgrind evidence	Preserved the genuine buggy run, GDB inspection and corrected verification.
34a400d	Riti - final evidence assets	Added the third Activity Diagram and Valgrind submission material.

Individual contributions

- **Riti Botha (Member 1):** implemented Composite and Iterator, created the recursive dispatch Activity Diagram, prepared memory-check evidence, contributed to the class diagram, Makefile and README.
- **Deon Steenkamp (Member 2):** implemented State and its valid/invalid transitions, created the State and lifecycle Activity Diagrams, documented the GDB investigation and contributed to the class diagram and report material.
- **Connor Human (Member 3):** implemented Decorator and the integrated runtime scenarios, created the Dockerfile, object diagram and emergency-response Activity Diagram, documented GoF participants and traversal policy, and assembled the final report.

Integration reflection

The Member2 branch provided a safe workspace for State development and was merged through PR #1. Later commits brought the pattern-specific work and evidence together on `main`. Final integration focused on traceability: the runtime output, diagrams, ownership policy and debugging evidence now describe the same implementation.

Repository: <https://github.com/Riti-Botha/COS-214-Practical-4>